

Mike Hall

Staff Software Engineer

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I am a Staff Software Engineer rooted in the profession of software engineering. I work at multiple levels of software engineering, from code and runtime behavior through business and organizational boundaries. I work with and across teams of individual contributors to turn business objectives into clear technical decisions, safer change, and durable ownership. As a Staff Engineer, I use evidence to make complex production software easier to understand and help teams accomplish the work that matters.

EXPERIENCE

Associate Director, Staff Engineer

OneMain Financial | Remote | January 2021 - February 2026

Software Engineer and architecture lead who recovered lost knowledge and made it actionable, helping make regulated customer workflows easier to understand, safer to change, and more observable across organizational boundaries.

- Mapped the loan acquisition and origination pipeline end-to-end from visit to booked loan across browser, mainframe, and Affiliate API, identifying seven distinct lending funnels.
- Built data-risk remediation and architecture-discovery practices that made legacy dependencies visible and safer to change.
- Diagnosed a production state-management defect affecting application completion and moved the system to a more durable session design without interrupting service.
- Established distributed observability across application and integration boundaries, improving the evidence available during incident response.
- Built communities of practice, mentoring loops, and handoff mechanisms that distributed technical ownership beyond a single engineer.

Senior Backend Developer

SK Holdings, Inc. | Chicago, IL | January 2019 - December 2020

Software Engineer focused on backend stability, performance, and safe modernization for high-traffic Rails products.

- Improved search and asynchronous delivery systems while production traffic continued to flow.
- Led framework and database upgrades with a staged approach designed to protect service continuity.

Senior Software Developer

ActiveCampaign | Chicago, IL | September 2018 - December 2018

Software Engineer on a large CRM platform, focused on testability, performance, and safer change inside a legacy backend.

- Replaced fragile data-access patterns with structured, testable queries and improved performance.
- Strengthened automated verification around core customer workflows, enabling safer refactoring.

SELECTED CURRENT WORK

Principal Architect

Local AI Orchestration & Developer Runtime | Independent Project

Built local-first tools that help engineers and AI systems work with clear context boundaries, observable behavior, and human-reviewed change.

- Built tools that make technical context reusable across sessions without treating generated output as authority.
- Added observable diagnostics and bounded review steps to keep automated engineering work understandable and reversible.

Principal Architect

Phalanx Duel | Independent Project

Building a real-time tactical game as a laboratory for deterministic systems, product architecture, and carefully bounded AI-assisted engineering.

- Designed replayable state transitions so complex outcomes remain reproducible and independently reviewable.
- Built verification gates that test system behavior across the full lifecycle.

Principal Architect

WWWorkRemote | Independent Project

Building a Rails platform for structured research, semantic search, and human-directed automation.

- Unified fragmented sources into a searchable data model for downstream analysis.
- Designed local-first AI workflows with explicit safety boundaries around untrusted input and sensitive context.

CORE CAPABILITIES & TECHNOLOGIES

ARCHITECTURE & MODERNIZATION	OBSERVABILITY & AI-AUGMENTED ENGINEERING	TECHNOLOGIES
• Legacy Modernization & Architecture Discovery, • Zero-Downtime Data Migration & Integrity, • Incident Response & Root Cause Analysis, • Distributed Systems & Asynchronous Processing	• OpenTelemetry & Observability Architecture, • Model Context Protocol (MCP) Server Design, • LLM Orchestration & Deterministic Evaluation, • Platform Enablement & Developer Velocity	• Ruby on Rails, PostgreSQL, Sidekiq & Redis, AWS, Kubernetes & Docker, CI/CD

SELECTED EARLIER EXPERIENCE

- **Senior Software Developer, BenchPrep** : Supported a learning platform with a focus on reliable delivery and maintainable application behavior.

- › **Senior Software Developer, ReachLocal** : Delivered backend and platform improvements for a multi-tenant product environment.
- › **Open-Source Transition Lead, Coderwall** : Helped evolve a developer-facing product while strengthening its engineering practices.
- › **Software Engineer & Technical Onboarding Lead (Fraud & Taxonomy Systems), Groupon** : Built production systems and engineering enablement practices during a period of rapid growth.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Selected earlier experience

Built and operated enterprise integrations, transactional systems, and early web products across consulting and product organizations, establishing the production discipline and community-centered craftsmanship that inform my leadership today.

- › **Revenue-critical commerce**: Designed real-time inventory, locking, and fulfillment services for a high-volume ticket marketplace later acquired by a major industry operator.
- › **Consulting and software craftsmanship**: Delivered systems across client environments while mentoring engineers, adopting Ruby and Rails, and helping build Chicago's craftsmanship community.
- › **Enterprise and operational systems**: Built integration and operational software across large organizations, grounded in .NET, SQL, messaging, production support, and direct user needs.